Forklift Daily Pre-Use Inspection Checklist

Powered industrial trucks: check before each shift

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.178(q)(7)

DATE	SHIFT
OPERATOR NAME	TRUCK ID / UNIT NO.
MAKE AND MODEL	HOUR METER READING
SITE / AREA	POWER TYPE

Before you start

1. Inspect the truck before it is used each shift. Mark one box for every item: OK, Defect or N/A.
2. If any defect affects safe operation, do not use the truck. Tag it out of service, remove the key and report it to your supervisor.
3. Do not return the truck to service until the defect is repaired. Add any checks your manufacturer's operator manual requires.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.178(q)(7): trucks must be examined before being placed in service, at least daily, and after each shift where used round the clock. A truck showing any condition that affects its safety must not be placed in service. Source: eCFR, Title 29, Part 1910, Subpart N. Checks are a general guide; follow the manufacturer's operator manual for your truck.

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-178-powered-industrial-trucks

SECTION A | Visual checks: power off, key removed

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Overall condition	No visible damage, loose or missing parts. No build-up of grease, dust or debris.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Leaks	No hydraulic oil, engine oil, coolant, fuel or battery acid under the truck.	☐	☐	☐	
3	Tyres and wheels	No cuts, gouges, chunks or embedded objects. Wheel nuts secure. Pneumatic tyres at correct pressure.	☐	☐	☐	
4	Forks	No cracks, bends or excessive heel wear. Both locking pins in place and engaged.	☐	☐	☐	
5	Mast and lift chains	Chains lubricated, no kinked, stretched or broken links. Anchor pins secure. Mast rails undamaged.	☐	☐	☐	
6	Load backrest	Fitted, secure, not bent or cracked.	☐	☐	☐	
7	Overhead guard	Fitted, secure, not bent or cracked.	☐	☐	☐	
8	Hydraulic hoses	No cracks, chafing, bulges or weeping fittings.	☐	☐	☐	
9	Capacity / data plate	Present, legible and correct for any attachment fitted.	☐	☐	☐	
10	Seat and seat belt	Seat secure. Belt latches and retracts, webbing not cut or frayed.	☐	☐	☐	
11	Fluid levels	Engine oil, hydraulic oil, coolant and brake fluid within marks, where applicable.	☐	☐	☐	
12	Decals and manual	Warning decals legible. Operator manual on the truck.	☐	☐	☐	
13	Fire extinguisher	Mounted, charged and in date, where fitted.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Operational checks: truck running, area clear

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
14	Gauges and warning lights	All read normal. No fault codes or warning lights left on.	☐	☐	☐	
15	Horn	Sounds clearly.	☐	☐	☐	
16	Lights, beacon and alarm	Headlights, beacon and travel/reversing alarm work, where fitted.	☐	☐	☐	
17	Steering	Turns smoothly lock to lock. No binding or excessive play.	☐	☐	☐	
18	Service brakes	Pedal firm. Truck stops smoothly and in a straight line.	☐	☐	☐	
19	Parking brake	Holds the truck. Warning light or alarm works, where fitted.	☐	☐	☐	
20	Seat switch / deadman	Drive and hydraulics cut out when the operator leaves the seat, where fitted.	☐	☐	☐	
21	Lift and lower	Smooth through full height. No jerking, drifting or chain slack.	☐	☐	☐	
22	Tilt	Smooth forward and back. Holds position with the lever released.	☐	☐	☐	
23	Side shift and attachments	Operate correctly and are secured to the carriage.	☐	☐	☐	
24	Unusual noise or vibration	None while travelling or using the hydraulics.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Power source: complete the item that applies, mark the others N/A

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
25	Electric: battery	Charged. Cables and connector undamaged. Terminals clean. Vent caps fitted. Battery restraint secure.	☐	☐	☐	
26	LPG: cylinder	Secured in its bracket with locating pin engaged. Relief valve at the top. Hose and fittings undamaged. No smell of gas.	☐	☐	☐	
27	Diesel / petrol: fuel	Enough fuel for the shift. Filler cap secure. No leaks. Exhaust undamaged, no heavy smoke.	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

TRUCK SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
OPERATOR SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW	DATE / TIME